

Figure 1.5 Soldering Iron with Desoldering Pump

Desolder wick (copper shield wire)

Desoldering braid, also known as desoldering wick or solder wick, is finely braided as 18 to 42 SWG(Standard Wire Gauge) copper wire coated with resin flux, usually supplied on a roll.

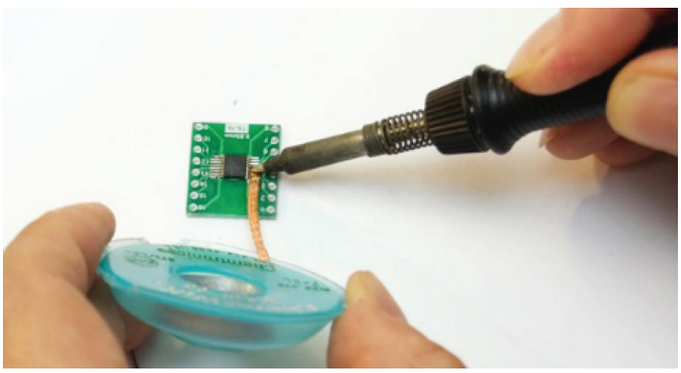




Figure 1.6 Wick

The end of a length of braid is placed over the soldered connections of a component being removed. The connections are heated with a soldering iron until the solder melts and is wicked into the braid by capillary action. The braid is removed while the solder is still molten, its used section cut off and discarded when cool. Short lengths of cut braid will prevent heat being carried away by the braid instead of heating the joint.

Soldering paste (flux):

During soldering, the Soldering paste or flux is used for the following reason.

1. Prevention of oxidation of molten solder.
2. Protect the heated surface against oxidation and the part which is to be soldered.
3. It helps in the flow of molten solder.

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